

Botany short course 2026

Inflorescences

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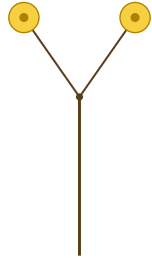
- The whole flowering shoot — including open flowers, buds, and spent flowers/fruits
- Knowing the **arrangement** of flowers is one of the first steps in the identification method we will use
- There are many types



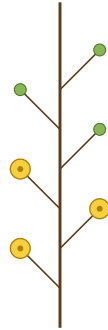
Simple inflorescences



Solitary (e.g. *Papaver*)



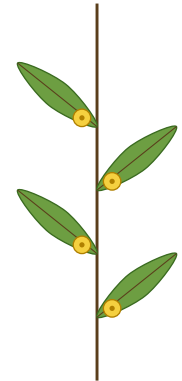
Pair (e.g. *Geranium*)



Raceme (e.g. *Chamaenerion*)

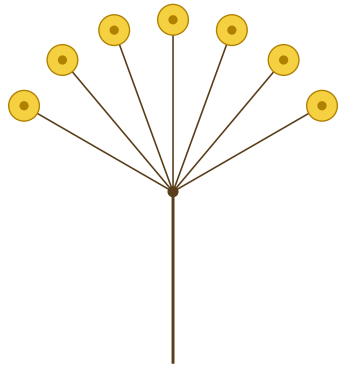


Spike (e.g. *Triticum*)

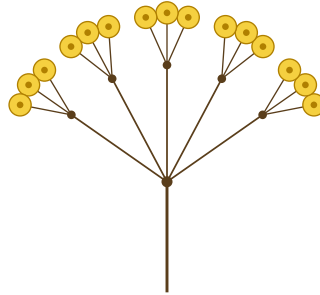


In leaf axils, (e.g. *Lamium*)

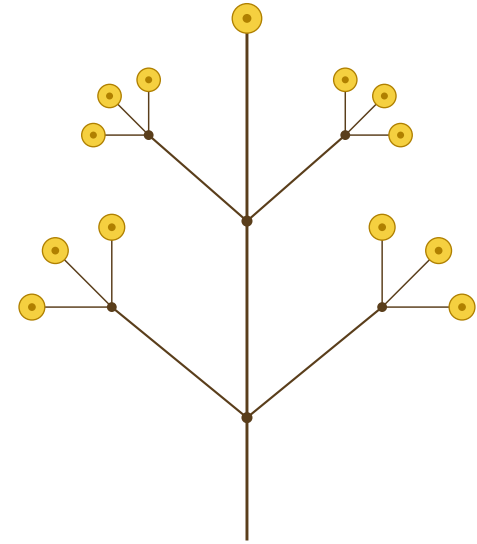
Complex inflorescences



Umbel (e.g. *Hedera*)

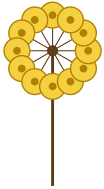


Compound umbel (e.g. *Anthriscus*)

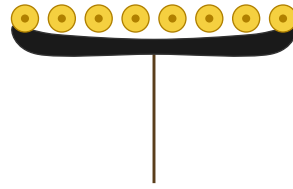


Panicle (e.g. *Scrophularia*)

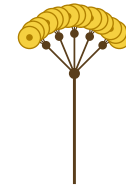
Tight heads



Tight head (umbel; e.g. *Astrantia*)



Tight head (capitulum; e.g. most Asteraceae)



Tight head (panicle; e.g. many Poaceae)